

الْقُرْآنُ الْكَرِيمُ

THE QUR'ĀN

English Meanings

English Revised and Edited by

Şaḥeeḥ International

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Al-Muntada Al-Islami

London + (44) (0) 20-7736-9060 fax: + (44) (0) 20-7736-4255
USA + (608) 277-1855 fax: + (608) 277-0323
Saudi Arabia + (966) (1) 464-1222 fax: + (966) (1) 464-1446

Quran@almontada.org

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بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

INTRODUCTION

All praise is due to Allāh; and blessings and peace be upon His messenger and servant, Muḥammad, and upon his family and companions and whoever follows his guidance until the Day of Resurrection.

There is clearly a need for a presentation of the meanings of the Holy Qur'ān in English which is precise enough to be useful as a reference for Muslims and students of Arabic yet also suitable for *da'wah* purposes to non-Muslims. The Arabic Qur'ān has always spoken for itself – to those who discover it for the first time as well as to those who study it in depth. The general meanings in a translation should thus be correct, as far as human ability permits, and clear, in a readable and uncomplicated expression.

Al-Muntadā al-Islāmi has selected this edition by Ṣaḥeeḥ International (first published by Abul-Qasim Publishing House, Jeddah, Saudi Arabia) as the one most suitable for distribution. Widely acknowledged for improvement over previous translations, its language closely adheres to that of the original text while remaining lucid and intelligible.

Without going into excessive detail, a word is due about the methodology of this abbreviated edition. Three main objectives served as guidelines for the work:

1. To present correct meanings, as far as possible, in accordance with the *'aqeedah* of *Ahl as-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah*
2. To simplify and clarify the language for the benefit of all readers
3. To let the Qur'ān speak for itself, adding footnotes only where deemed necessary for explanation of points not readily understood or when more than one meaning is acceptable

Each verse was reviewed in Arabic with reference to several works of *tafseer* and grammar. Where differences arose, explanations were generally taken from an authentic *ḥadīth* or, in the absence of

such, those by the most knowledgeable of the *ṣaḥābah* and *ṭābiʿūn* as quoted by Ibn Katheer.¹

English word order was chosen to conform more closely with that of the Arabic text. This facilitates comparison for the student, and the reader is brought somewhat closer to the feel of the original expression. Transliterated Arabic terms have been avoided wherever an English definition could serve, keeping exceptions to a minimum. Necessary clarifications or additions are given in footnotes. Care has also been taken to avoid the definitions of modern Arabic dictionaries, which are often variant with the language of the Qurʾān and reflect the degree of change which has crept into the understanding of certain concepts with the passing of time. Instead, classical definitions were applied.

In compliance with standard regulations, words not derived from the Arabic text but added for the purpose of clarification or the completion of English meaning have been enclosed in brackets. The exception is in regard to the frequently occurring expressions of "association of another with Allāh" (*shirk*) and "fearing Allāh" (*taqwā*), where the divine name, although not always included in the Arabic text, is understood to be an integral part of that concept. Throughout this work there is an endeavor to be consistent in the translation of oft-repeated words and phrases from the text. There are, however, specific instances where some adjustment is required for accuracy, necessitating exceptions to the rule.

¹The *ṣaḥābah* (companions) were those most familiar with the time, place and circumstances of each revelation due to their close contact with the Prophet (ﷺ) and their eagerness to understand its every aspect. At the same time, acute awareness of their accountability before Allāh prevented them from answering any questions or making assertions about that of which they were not completely certain.

The *ṭābiʿūn* (followers) were students of the *ṣaḥābah* who mentioned the sources for whatever commentaries they offered. Of their statements only those based upon knowledge taken from the *ṣaḥābah* and upon the literal and logical meanings understood in the Arabic language have been accepted. Explanations from other sources, such as Jewish and Christian narratives, are disregarded as unreliable.

It is to be noted that Arabic is a richer language than most. One well versed therein automatically perceives the multiple shades of meaning contained in particular words and phrases. Both early and later scholars emphasized some aspects more than others in their commentaries according to their own understanding, especially in the absence of a relevant and authentic prophetic *ḥadīth*. Any translation, which can reflect but one emphasis, must necessarily appear as a severe limitation. Although additions in brackets and explanatory footnotes are a partial remedy, it remains to be said that nothing can take the place of an in-depth study through the Arabic medium itself.

Arabic is richer not only in vocabulary but also in grammatical possibilities. Again, English is hardly comparable in this respect. While precise and logical, Arabic grammar is free of many limitations found in that of other languages, allowing for much wider expression. For this reason, undoubtedly, it was the most suitable of human tongues for conveyance of the Creator's message to mankind. Due to the flexibility of Arabic tenses, the Qur'ān is unique in its graphic portrayal of occurrences in the Hereafter. Through use of the past tense the feeling is given that one is already there, having experienced what is described. Much of this is lost in English, where such descriptions are confined to "will" of the future.

Those unfamiliar with Qur'ānic style might question the shifting of pronouns in many verses, which is again, alien to English. This cannot be eliminated in translation, however, without loss to intended meanings. Far from showing inconsistency, such variations are not only correct in the original language but are the source of its beauty and precision, which unfortunately cannot be captured in another tongue. It must be remembered that the Arabic Qur'ān, being the words of Allāh, the Exalted, far surpasses any human endeavor in linguistic excellence and is indeed the standard of perfection for all Arabic expression.

As for the names and attributes of Allāh, their translation is surely an impossibility, for even in Arabic they cannot represent

more than an approximation limited by human understanding. To any description given by Allāh of Himself in human terminology, the mind is required to apply the concept of absoluteness and perfection befitting Him. Ibn Taymiyyah stated consisely that true belief in Allāh (i.e., the correct Islāmic '*aqeedah* of *Ahl as-Sunnah*) includes belief in whatever is described in His Book (the Qur'ān) or through His Prophet (Muḥammad ﷺ) – belief that is free from distortion,² suspension,³ qualification⁴ or comparison.⁵ The same can be said for those aspects of the unseen, such as Paradise and Hellfire, which are beyond the limits of human language and human imagination.

In this edition particular attention has been given to the names "*ar-Raḥmān ar-Raḥeem*" (explained in a footnote to *Sūrah al-Fātiḥah*, verse 1). Since both express certain aspects of divine mercy, "the Most Merciful" was used for *ar-Raḥmān* and simply "the Merciful" for *ar-Raḥeem*. However, when they occur together, as in *Sūrah al-Fātiḥah*, the adjectives "entirely" and "especially" have been used to indicate the complementary relationship between the two.

To those who use this volume, it should be emphasized that whenever in doubt, one should refer to dictionaries of the classical language and to reliable Arabic *tafseer*. Despite the many technicalities involved in a work of this sort that can predispose it to possible imperfections, al-Muntadā is optimistic that the present effort will contribute to a better understanding of the Qur'ān for English-speaking people in every part of the world.

Ultimately, all success is from Allāh,
and all praise is due to Him.

²*Tahreef*: Applying an allegorical meaning which will inevitably be incorrect since it is not based upon knowledge.

³*Ta'teel*: Desertion of the concept altogether or denial that Allāh would have such an attribute or quality.

⁴*Takyef*: Attempting to explain how a certain attribute or quality could be, while such knowledge lies only with Allāh.

⁵*Tamtheel*: Supposing that divine attributes resemble those of creation, while Allāh has said, "*There is nothing like unto Him.*" (42:11)

FOREWORD

Scholars have defined the Qur'ān as "the words of Allāh⁶ revealed to Muḥammad (ﷺ), the recitation of which is a form of worship."⁷ This definition can be applied to no other book or speech.

Reading and recitation of the Qur'ān is an important form of worship for which a Muslim can expect reward and benefit in the Hereafter. There was a definite purpose behind the strong encouragement given by the Prophet (ﷺ) in several authentic *ḥadīths* for recitation of the Qur'ān.⁸ That purpose is clearly stated in the Qur'ān itself:

﴿كِتَابٌ أَنْزَلْنَاهُ إِلَيْكَ مُبَارَكٌ لِيَدَّبَّرُوا آيَاتِهِ وَلِيَتَذَكَّرَ أُولُوا الْأَلْبَابِ﴾

"A blessed Book which We have revealed to you, [O Muḥammad], that they might reflect upon its verses and that those of understanding would be reminded."⁹

﴿أَفَلَا يَتَذَكَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ أَمْ عَلَى قُلُوبٍ أَقْفَالُهَا﴾

"Then do they not reflect upon the Qur'ān, or are there locks upon [their] hearts?"¹⁰

﴿أَفَلَا يَتَذَكَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ وَلَوْ كَانَ مِنْ عِنْدِ غَيْرِ اللَّهِ لَوَجَدُوا فِيهِ اخْتِلَافًا كَثِيرًا﴾

"Then do they not reflect upon the Qur'ān? If it had been from [any] other than Allāh, they would have found within it much contradiction."¹¹

⁶"Allāh" is the proper name of God and is not used to denote any other being. Therefore, this name is retained in translation to other languages.

⁷Al-Qaṭṭān, Mannā', *Mabāḥiṭh fi 'Ulūm il-Qur'ān*, p. 21.

⁸The recitation whose merits are mentioned in the *ḥadīths* is that of the actual words of Allāh in their original Arabic form. Nevertheless, any effort toward understanding the Qur'ān's meanings in order to increase faith, obtain guidance and live by its ordinances is in itself a deed of great merit.

⁹*Sūrah Ṣād*, 38:29.

¹⁰*Sūrah Muḥammad*, 47:24.

¹¹*Sūrah an-Nisā'*, 4:82.

Shaykh al-Islām Aḥmad bin Taymiyyah pointed out in his *Fatāwā* that even the ordinary words of men are spoken or written for the purpose of being understood by the listener or reader and that the Qur’ān is surely more worthy of being understood than the words of men. Many scholars have stated that it is the responsibility of all Muslims to learn the Arabic language in order to understand the Qur’ān. Ibn Katheer, author of the well-known Arabic *tafseer*, maintained that it is also the duty of Muslim scholars to make its meanings known to the people.

No person can afford to be ignorant of the Qur’ān, for it is the constitution revealed by Allāh to regulate and govern human life. It speaks with the perfect knowledge of the Creator about His creation. It exposes the truth and invites man to the way of truth. It contains important information about human destiny and that of the individual. It educates and raises men to the highest moral, intellectual and social level when they strive to comprehend it and apply its teachings to life.

Moreover, it is the actual words of Allāh – not created, but revealed by Him through the angel Gabriel to a human messenger, Muḥammad bin ‘Abdullāh (ﷺ), for the benefit of humanity. It is an eternal miracle given to the final prophet, Muḥammad (ﷺ), as proof of his prophethood and a challenge to all succeeding generations. It is of unique and inimitable quality. Revealed fourteen centuries ago, it remains today completely intact and unaltered in its original Arabic form.

What does one discover when he understands the meanings of the Qur’ān? The answers to this question can be classified in four main categories:

1. That he can know his Creator as He has described Himself
2. That he can know the purpose of life on this earth and what is expected of every person during this life
3. That he becomes aware of the consequences of his attitudes and his behavior
4. How he should relate to all things – to Allāh by worship and obedience, to his fellow man by justice to all or by

iḥsān (a higher degree),¹² and to the universe in general by putting those things under his control to good use

This divine message was revealed to confirm and renew the relationship between man and his Creator and to reinstate the sincere and correct worship of the one true God, Allāh (*subḥānahu wa ta'ālā*), who says:

﴿فَاسْتَجِيبُوا لِي وَلْيُؤْمِنُوا بِي لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْشُدُونَ﴾

"Then let them respond to Me and believe in Me that they may be [rightly] guided."¹³

¹²*Iḥsān* has been defined by the Prophet (ﷺ) as "worshipping Allāh as if you see Him" or generally, doing more than one's duty and expecting less than one's right.

¹³*Sūrah al-Baqarah*, 2:186.

HISTORY OF QUR'ĀN COMPILATION

1. In addition to its memorization in entirety by many of the *ṣaḥābah* (the Prophet's companions), written recording of the Qur'ān began during the Prophet's lifetime. As it was recited by him, his scribes wrote down the revelation on pieces of leather, bone and palm leaves, and its verses were ordered and arranged as Allāh revealed. Initially, the Qur'ān was not compiled in one volume, although some of the *ṣaḥābah* had made personal copies for themselves after memorizing it from the Prophet (ﷺ).
2. Collecting and compiling the Qur'ān followed soon after the Prophet's death, during the caliphate of Abū Bakr aṣ-Ṣiddeeq. Upon the advice of 'Umar bin al-Khaṭṭāb, Abū Bakr charged Zayd bin Thābit to bring all of the Qur'ān together on written sheets (*ṣuḥuf*). These were checked for accuracy against what had been memorized by a great number of the *ṣaḥābah*. After the death of Abū Bakr and then 'Umar, the collection remained with 'Umar's daughter, Ḥafṣah, who was also the Prophet's wife.
3. The standardization of one authentic volume (*muṣḥaf*) took place during the caliphate of 'Uthmān bin 'Affān. The copy kept by Ḥafṣah was obtained and, upon the order of 'Uthmān, it was transcribed with great care by four of the most knowledgeable scribes: Zayd bin Thābit, 'Abdullāh bin az-Zubayr, Sa'eed bin al-'Aaṣ and 'Abdur-Raḥmān bin al-Ḥārith bin Hishām. Copies were sent to each of the various Islamic territories to replace all other collections in circulation. 'Uthmān kept a copy in Madinah, and the original *ṣuḥuf* were returned to Ḥafṣah. There is consensus by the *ṣaḥābah* that what is contained in this standard copy is the true revelation received by Muḥammad (ﷺ) from Allāh, the Exalted.
4. The *muṣḥaf* of 'Uthmān had no dots or vowel marks, as they were unnecessary for those who knew the pure Arabic tongue. With the spread of Islām among other peoples, there arose a need to guard against incorrect reading and misinterpretation of the Qur'ān. At first, scholars were reluctant about these additions, but it was finally agreed that they did not affect the text itself and

were merely aids to proper pronunciation and understanding. They were introduced in three stages:

- ♦ Short vowel sounds were first represented by dots positioned above, below and to the left of the letter. This system was introduced during the caliphate of Mu'āwiyah bin Abī Sufyān by Abul-Aswad ad-Du'li after he had heard serious errors in recitation of the Qur'ān.
- ♦ Similarly written letters were differentiated by another system of dots above and below them during the caliphate of 'Abdul-Malik bin Marwān. At the caliph's order, his governor, al-Ḥajjāj, appointed two scholars, Naṣr bin 'Āṣim and Ḥayy bin Ya'mūr, to implement this improvement.
- ♦ The presently used system of short vowel symbols was devised by al-Khaleel bin Aḥmad al-Farāheedī during the Abbāsine period.

MERITS OF PARTICULAR SŪRAHS AND VERSES

1. Abū Sa'eed Rāfi' bin al-Mu'allā said: "Allāh's Messenger (ﷺ) said, 'Shall I not teach you the most superior *sūrah* in the Qur'ān before you leave the mosque?' He took me by the hand. When we were about to leave, I said, 'O Messenger of Allāh, you said you would teach me the most superior *sūrah* in the Qur'ān.' The Prophet (ﷺ) said, **"Praise to Allāh, Lord of the worlds"** [i.e., *Sūrah al-Fātiḥah*]; it is the seven repeatedly recited verses and the magnificent Qur'ān which was given to me.'" (Narrated by al-Bukhārī.)
2. Ibn 'Abbās narrated: "While Gabriel was sitting with the Prophet (ﷺ), he heard a creaking sound above him, and raising his head he said, 'This is a gate opened in Heaven today which has never been opened before.' Then when an angel descended through it, he said, 'This is an angel that came down to earth who has never come down before.' He gave a salutation and said, 'Rejoice in two lights brought to you which have not been brought to any prophet before you: *Fātiḥat al-Kitāb* and the last verses of *Sūrah al-Baqarah*. You will not recite a letter of them without being given the blessing it contains.'" (Narrated by Muslim.)
3. Abū Hurayrah narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "Do not make your houses into graveyards. The devil flees from the house in which *Sūrah al-Baqarah* is recited." (Narrated by Muslim.)
4. Ubayy bin Ka'b narrated: "Allāh's Messenger (ﷺ) said, 'Abul-Mundhir, do you know which verse of Allāh's Book you have is greatest?' I replied, **'Allāh – there is no deity except Him, the Ever-Living, the Sustainer of [all] existence.'** [2:255] Thereupon he struck me on the breast and said, 'May knowledge be pleasant for you, Abul-Mundhir.'" (Narrated by Muslim.)
5. Abū Mas'ūd al-Badrī narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "If anyone recites the last two verses of *Sūrah al-Baqarah* at night, it will be sufficient for him." (Narrated by al-Bukhārī and Muslim.)

6. Abū Umāmah al-Bāhili narrated that he heard Allāh's Messenger (ﷺ) say: "Recite the Qur'ān, for on the Day of Resurrection it will come as an intercessor for those who recite it. Recite the two bright ones, *al-Baqarah* and *Āli 'Imrān*, for on the Day of Resurrection they will come as two clouds or two shades or two flocks of birds in ranks pleading for those who recite them. Recite *Sūrah al-Baqarah*, for reading it produces blessing, and abandoning it produces regret. And magicians are unable to recite it." (Narrated by Muslim.)
7. Abū Dardā' narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "If anyone learns by heart the first ten verses of *Sūrah al-Kahf*, he will be protected from the Dajjāl." In another version, he said: "...at the end of *Sūrah al-Kahf*." (Narrated by Muslim.)
8. Abū Sa'eed narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "If anyone recites *Sūrah al-Kahf* on Friday, light will shine brightly for him until the next Friday." (Narrated by al-Hākim and al-Bayhaqī – an authentic *ḥadīth*.)
9. Ibn Mas'ūd narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "*Sūrah Tabarak* prevents [whoever reads it] from the punishment of the grave." (Narrated by al-Hākim and Abū Na'eem – an authentic *ḥadīth*.)
10. Ibn 'Umar narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "Whoever would like to see the Day of Resurrection as if with his own eyes may recite *Sūrah al-Takweer*, *al-Infīṭār* and *al-Inshiqāq*." (Narrated by Aḥmad, at-Tirmidhī and al-Hākim – a good *ḥadīth*.)
11. Abū Sa'eed al-Khudrī narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said regarding, "**Say He is Allāh, [who is] One**" (i.e., *Sūrah al-Ikhlāṣ*): "By Him in whose hand my life is, this *sūrah* is equal to one third of the Qur'ān." And in another *ḥadīth*: "The Prophet (ﷺ) said to his companions, 'Is it difficult for any of you to recite one third of the Qur'ān in one night?' This was difficult for them, so they said, 'Who among us has the ability to do so, O Messenger of Allāh?' Allāh's Messenger (ﷺ) replied, "**Say, He is Allāh, the One; Allāh, the Eternal, Absolute**" [i.e., *Sūrah al-Ikhlāṣ*] is equal to one third of the Qur'ān." (Narrated by al-Bukhārī.)

12. Mu'adh bin Anas narrated that the Prophet (ﷺ) said: "If someone recites, '**Say, He is Allāh, the One**' ten times, Allāh will build for him a palace in Paradise." (Narrated by Ahmad.)
13. 'Uqbah bin 'Āmir narrated that Allāh's Messenger (ﷺ) said: "What wonderful verses have been sent down tonight. The like of them has never been seen! They are: '**Say, I seek refuge in the Lord of the dawn,**' and '**Say, I seek refuge in the Lord of men.**'" (i.e., *Sūrah al-Falaq* and *an-Nās*) (Narrated by Muslim.)
14. 'Ā'ishah narrated: "When the Prophet (ﷺ) went to bed every night, he used to cup his hands together and blow over them after reciting *Sūrah al-Ikhlāṣ*, *Sūrah al-Falaq* and *Sūrah an-Nās* and then rub his hands over whatever parts of his body he was able to, starting with his head, face and front of his body. He used to do that three times." (Narrated by al-Bukhārī and Muslim.)
15. 'Abdullāh bin Yūsuf said that Mālik reported from Ibn Shihāb from 'Urwah that 'Ā'ishah narrated: "Whenever Allāh's Messenger (ﷺ) became sick, he would recite the *mu'awwidhāt* [i.e., *Sūrah al-Falaq* and *an-Nās*] and then blow over his body. But when he became seriously ill, I used to recite them and rub his hands over his body hoping for their blessings." (Narrated by al-Bukhārī.)

*Sūrah al-Fātiḥah*¹

1. In the name of Allāh,² the Entirely Merciful, the Especially Merciful.³
2. [All] praise is [due] to Allāh, Lord⁴ of the worlds –
3. The Entirely Merciful, the Especially Merciful,
4. Sovereign of the Day of Recompense.⁵
5. It is You we worship and You we ask for help.
6. Guide us to the straight path –
7. The path of those upon whom You have bestowed favor, not of those who have evoked [Your] anger or of those who are astray.

¹*Al-Fātiḥah*: The Opening (of the Qur'ān). Note: *Sūrah* titles are not an integral part of the Qur'ān. A distinguishing word in a particular *sūrah* or a word defining its subject matter often became a common means of identification among the Prophet's companions and later scholars. Although some names, such as *al-Fātiḥah*, were used by the Prophet (ﷺ) in reference to a particular *sūrah*, they were not specifically designated by him as titles.

²Allāh is a proper name belonging only to the one Almighty God, Creator and Sustainer of the heavens and the earth and all that is within them, the Eternal and Absolute, to whom alone all worship is due.

³*Ar-Raḥmān* and *ar-Raḥeem* are two names of Allāh derived from the word "*raḥmah*" (mercy). In Arabic grammar both are intensive forms of "merciful" (i.e., extremely merciful). A complimentary and comprehensive meaning is intended by using both together.

Raḥmān is used only to describe Allāh, while *raḥeem* might be used to describe a person as well. The Prophet (ﷺ) was described in the Qur'ān as *raḥeem*. *Raḥmān* is above the human level (i.e., intensely merciful). Since one usually understands intensity to be something of short duration, Allāh describes Himself also as *raḥeem* (i.e., continually merciful).

Raḥmān also carries a wider meaning – merciful to all creation. Justice is a part of this mercy. *Raḥeem* includes the concept of speciality – especially and specifically merciful to the believers. Forgiveness is a part of this mercy. (See al-Qurṭubī's *al-Jāmi'u li Ahkām al-Qur'ān*, pp. 103-107.)

⁴When referring to Allāh (*subḥānahu wa ta'ālā*), the Arabic term "*rabb*" (translated as "Lord") includes all of the following meanings: "owner, master, ruler, controller, sustainer, provider, guardian and caretaker."

⁵i.e., repayment and compensation for whatever was earned of good or evil during life on this earth.

Sūrah al-Baqarah⁶

Bismillāhir-Raḥmānir-Raḥeem

1. Alif, Lām, Meem.⁷
2. This is the Book about which there is no doubt, a guidance for those conscious of Allāh⁸ –
3. Who believe in the unseen, establish prayer,⁹ and spend out of what We¹⁰ have provided for them,
4. And who believe in what has been revealed to you, [O Muḥammad], and what was revealed before you, and of the Hereafter they are certain [in faith].
5. Those are upon [right] guidance from their Lord, and it is those who are the successful.
6. Indeed, those who disbelieve¹¹ – it is all the same for them whether you warn them or do not warn them – they will not believe.
7. Allāh has set a seal upon their hearts and upon their hearing, and over their vision is a veil.¹² And for them is a great punishment.

⁶*Al-Baqarah*: The Cow. The name is taken from the story in verses 67-73.

⁷These are among the fourteen opening letters which occur in various combinations at the beginning of twenty-nine *sūrahs* in the Qur'ān. Although there has been much speculation as to their meaning, it was not, in fact, revealed by Allāh to anyone and is known only to Him.

⁸Literally, "those who have *taqwā*," i.e., who have piety, righteousness, fear and love of Allāh, and who take great care to avoid His displeasure.

⁹At its proper times and according to its specified conditions.

¹⁰It is to be noted that the reference of Allāh (*subḥānahu wa ta'ālā*) to Himself as "We" in many Qur'ānic verses is necessarily understood in the Arabic language to denote grandeur and power, as opposed to the more intimate singular form "I" used in specific instances.

¹¹Literally, "cover" or "conceal" (faith or truth).

¹²A covering preventing them from discerning guidance. This condition is a direct result of their arrogance and persistence in sin.

8. And of the people are some who say, "We believe in Allāh and the Last Day," but they are not believers.
9. They [think to] deceive Allāh and those who believe, but they deceive not except themselves and perceive [it] not.
10. In their hearts is disease, so Allāh has increased their disease;¹³ and for them is a painful punishment because they [habitually] used to lie.
11. And when it is said to them, "Do not cause corruption on the earth," they say, "We are but reformers."
12. Unquestionably, it is they who are the corrupters, but they perceive [it] not.
13. And when it is said to them, "Believe as the people have believed," they say, "Should we believe as the foolish have believed?" Unquestionably, it is they who are the foolish, but they know [it] not.
14. And when they meet those who believe, they say, "We believe"; but when they are alone with their evil ones, they say, "Indeed, we are with you; we were only mockers."
15. [But] Allāh mocks them and prolongs them in their transgression [while] they wander blindly.
16. Those are the ones who have purchased error [in exchange] for guidance, so their transaction has brought no profit, nor were they guided.
17. Their example is that of one who kindled a fire, but when it illuminated what was around him, Allāh took away their light and left them in darkness [so] they could not see.
18. Deaf, dumb and blind – so they will not return [to the right path].
19. Or [it is] like a rainstorm from the sky within which is darkness, thunder and lightning. They put their fingers in

¹³The "disease" mentioned here includes doubt, hypocrisy, arrogance and disbelief.

their ears against the thunderclaps in dread of death. But Allāh is encompassing¹⁴ of the disbelievers.

20. The lightning almost snatches away their sight. Every time it lights [the way] for them, they walk therein; but when darkness comes over them, they stand [still]. And if Allāh had willed, He could have taken away their hearing and their sight. Indeed, Allāh is over all things competent.
21. O mankind, worship your Lord, who created you and those before you, that you may become righteous –
22. [He] who made for you the earth a bed [spread out] and the sky a ceiling and sent down from the sky, rain and brought forth thereby fruits as provision for you. So do not attribute to Allāh equals while you know [that there is nothing similar to Him].
23. And if you are in doubt about what We have sent down [i.e., the Qur'ān] upon Our Servant [i.e., Prophet Muḥammad (ﷺ)], then produce a sūrah the like thereof and call upon your witnesses [i.e., supporters] other than Allāh, if you should be truthful.
24. But if you do not – and you will never be able to – then fear the Fire, whose fuel is men and stones, prepared for the disbelievers.
25. And give good tidings to those who believe and do righteous deeds that they will have gardens [in Paradise] beneath which rivers flow. Whenever they are provided with a provision of fruit therefrom, they will say, "This is what we were provided

¹⁴ Allāh states in the Qur'ān that He has certain attributes such as hearing, sight, hands, face, mercy, anger, coming, encompassing, being above the Throne, etc. Yet, He has disassociated Himself from the limitations of human attributes or human imagination. Correct Islāmic belief requires faith in the existence of these attributes as Allāh has described them without applying to them any allegorical meanings or attempting to explain how a certain quality could be (while this is known only to Allāh) and without comparing them to creation or denying that He (*subḥānahu wa ta'ālā*) would have such a quality. His attributes are befitting to Him alone, and "*There is nothing like unto Him.*" (42:11)

with before." And it is given to them in likeness. And they will have therein purified spouses, and they will abide therein eternally.

26. Indeed, Allāh is not timid to present an example – that of a mosquito or what is smaller¹⁵ than it. And those who have believed know that it is the truth from their Lord. But as for those who disbelieve, they say, "What did Allāh intend by this as an example?" He misleads many thereby and guides many thereby. And He misleads not except the defiantly disobedient,
27. Who break the covenant of Allāh after contracting it and sever that which Allāh has ordered to be joined and cause corruption on earth. It is those who are the losers.
28. How can you disbelieve in Allāh when you were lifeless and He brought you to life; then He will cause you to die, then He will bring you [back] to life, and then to Him you will be returned.
29. It is He who created for you all of that which is on the earth. Then He directed Himself¹⁶ to the heaven, [His being above all creation], and made them seven heavens, and He is Knowing of all things.
30. And [mention, O Muḥammad], when your Lord said to the angels, "Indeed, I will make upon the earth a successive authority."¹⁷ They said, "Will You place upon it one who causes corruption therein and sheds blood, while we declare Your praise and sanctify You?" He [Allāh] said, "Indeed, I know that which you do not know."
31. And He taught Adam the names – all of them. Then He showed them to the angels and said, "Inform Me of the names of these, if you are truthful."
32. They said, "Exalted are You; we have no knowledge except

¹⁵Literally, "above it," i.e., greater in smallness.

¹⁶See footnote to 2:19.

¹⁷*Khalifah*: successor, or generations of man, one following another.

what You have taught us. Indeed, it is You who is the Knowing, the Wise."

33. He said, "O Adam, inform them of their names." And when he had informed them of their names, He said, "Did I not tell you that I know the unseen [aspects] of the heavens and the earth? And I know what you reveal and what you have concealed."
34. And [mention] when We said to the angels, "Prostrate before Adam"; so they prostrated, except for Iblees.¹⁸ He refused and was arrogant and became of the disbelievers.
35. And We said, "O Adam, dwell, you and your wife, in Paradise and eat therefrom in [ease and] abundance from wherever you will. But do not approach this tree, lest you be among the wrongdoers."
36. But Satan caused them to slip out of it and removed them from that [condition] in which they had been. And We said, "Go down, [all of you], as enemies to one another, and you will have upon the earth a place of settlement and provision for a time."
37. Then Adam received from his Lord [some] words,¹⁹ and He accepted his repentance. Indeed, it is He who is the Accepting of repentance, the Merciful.
38. We said, "Go down from it, all of you. And when guidance comes to you from Me, whoever follows My guidance – there will be no fear concerning them, nor will they grieve.
39. And those who disbelieve and deny Our signs – those will be companions of the Fire; they will abide therein eternally."
40. O Children of Israel, remember My favor which I have bestowed upon you and fulfill My covenant [upon you] that I will fulfill your covenant [from Me], and be afraid of [only] Me.

¹⁸The proper name of Satan, who was not an angel but from the *jinn*, as stated in 18:50. Done in obedience to Allāh, this prostration was one of respect, not worship.

¹⁹Allāh taught Adam words of repentance that would be acceptable to Him.

41. And believe in what I have sent down confirming that which is [already] with you, and be not the first to disbelieve in it. And do not exchange My signs for a small price, and fear [only] Me.
42. And do not mix the truth with falsehood or conceal the truth while you know [it].
43. And establish prayer and give zakāh²⁰ and bow with those who bow [in worship and obedience].
44. Do you order righteousness of the people and forget²¹ yourselves while you recite the Scripture? Then will you not reason?
45. And seek help through patience and prayer; and indeed, it is difficult except for the humbly submissive [to Allāh]
46. Who are certain that they will meet their Lord and that they will return to Him.
47. O Children of Israel, remember My favor that I have bestowed upon you and that I preferred you over the worlds [i.e., peoples].
48. And fear a Day when no soul will suffice for another soul²² at all, nor will intercession be accepted from it, nor will compensation be taken from it, nor will they be aided.
49. And [recall] when We saved you [i.e., your forefathers] from the people of Pharaoh, who afflicted you with the worst torment, slaughtering your [newborn] sons and keeping your females alive. And in that was a great trial from your Lord.
50. And [recall] when We parted the sea for you and saved you and drowned the people of Pharaoh while you were looking on.
51. And [recall] when We made an appointment with Moses for forty nights. Then you took [for worship] the calf after him [i.e., his departure], while you were wrongdoers.

²⁰ An annual expenditure for the benefit of the Islāmic community (see 9:60) required of those Muslims who have excess wealth. Prayer and zakāh are among the pillars of Islām.

²¹ Make exceptions of.

²² i.e., fulfill what is due from it.

52. Then We forgave you after that so perhaps you would be grateful.
53. And [recall] when We gave Moses the Scripture and criterion²³ that perhaps you would be guided.
54. And [recall] when Moses said to his people, "O my people, indeed you have wronged yourselves by your taking of the calf [for worship]. So repent to your Creator and kill yourselves [i.e., the guilty among you]. That is best for [all of] you in the sight of your Creator." Then He accepted your repentance; indeed, He is the Accepting of repentance, the Merciful.
55. And [recall] when you said, "O Moses, we will never believe you until we see Allāh outright"; so the thunderbolt took you while you were looking on.
56. Then We revived you after your death that perhaps you would be grateful.
57. And We shaded you with clouds and sent down to you manna and quails, [saying], "Eat from the good things with which We have provided you." And they wronged Us not – but they were [only] wronging themselves.
58. And [recall] when We said, "Enter this city [i.e., Jerusalem] and eat from it wherever you will in [ease and] abundance, and enter the gate bowing humbly²⁴ and say, 'Relieve us of our burdens [i.e., sins].' We will [then] forgive your sins for you, and We will increase the doers of good [in goodness and reward]."
59. But those who wronged changed [those words] to a statement other than that which had been said to them, so We sent down upon those who wronged a punishment [i.e., plague] from the sky because they were defiantly disobeying.
60. And [recall] when Moses prayed for water for his people, so We said, "Strike with your staff the stone." And there gushed forth from it twelve springs, and every people [i.e., tribe] knew

²³Differentiating between truth and falsehood. "The Scripture and criterion" refers to the Torah.

²⁴In gratitude to Allāh and admission of sin.

its watering place. "Eat and drink from the provision of Allāh, and do not commit abuse on the earth, spreading corruption."

61. And [recall] when you said, "O Moses, we can never endure one [kind of] food. So call upon your Lord to bring forth for us from the earth its green herbs and its cucumbers and its garlic and its lentils and its onions." [Moses] said, "Would you exchange what is better for what is less? Go into [any] settlement and indeed, you will have what you have asked." And they were covered with humiliation and poverty and returned with anger from Allāh [upon them]. That was because they [repeatedly] disbelieved in the signs of Allāh and killed the prophets without right. That was because they disobeyed and were [habitually] transgressing.
62. Indeed, those who believed and those who were Jews or Christians or Sabeans [before Prophet Muḥammad (ﷺ)] – those [among them] who believed in Allāh and the Last Day and did righteousness – will have their reward with their Lord, and no fear will there be concerning them, nor will they grieve.²⁵
63. And [recall] when We took your covenant, [O Children of Israel, to abide by the Torah] and We raised over you the mount, [saying], "Take what We have given you with determination and remember what is in it that perhaps you may become righteous."
64. Then you turned away after that. And if not for the favor of Allāh upon you and His mercy, you would have been among the losers.
65. And you had already known about those who transgressed among you concerning the sabbath, and We said to them, "Be apes, despised."
66. And We made it a deterrent punishment for those who were present and those who succeeded [them] and a lesson for those who fear Allāh.

²⁵After the coming of Prophet Muḥammad (ﷺ) no religion other than Islām is acceptable to Allāh, as stated in 3:85.

67. And [recall] when Moses said to his people, "Indeed, Allāh commands you to slaughter a cow." They said, "Do you take us in ridicule?" He said, "I seek refuge in Allāh from being among the ignorant."
68. They said, "Call upon your Lord to make clear to us what it is." [Moses] said, "[Allāh] says, 'It is a cow which is neither old nor virgin, but median between that,' so do what you are commanded."
69. They said, "Call upon your Lord to show us what is her color." He said, "He says, 'It is a yellow cow, bright in color – pleasing to the observers.'"
70. They said, "Call upon your Lord to make clear to us what it is. Indeed, [all] cows look alike to us. And indeed we, if Allāh wills, will be guided."
71. He said, "He says, 'It is a cow neither trained to plow the earth nor to irrigate the field, one free from fault with no spot upon her.'"
72. And [recall] when you slew a man and disputed²⁶ over it, but Allāh was to bring out that which you were concealing.
73. So We said, "Strike him [i.e., the slain man] with part of it."²⁷ Thus does Allāh bring the dead to life, and He shows you His signs that you might reason.
74. Then your hearts became hardened after that, being like stones or even harder. For indeed, there are stones from which rivers burst forth, and there are some of them that split open and water comes out, and there are some of them that fall down for fear of Allāh. And Allāh is not unaware of what you do.
75. Do you covet [the hope, O believers], that they would believe for you while a party of them used to hear the words of Allāh

²⁶i.e., exchanged accusations and denials.

²⁷i.e., the cow. Thereupon, Allāh restored life to the man, who informed them of his murderer.

and then distort it [i.e., the Torah] after they had understood it while they were knowing?

76. And when they meet those who believe, they say, "We have believed"; but when they are alone with one another, they say, "Do you talk to them about what Allāh has revealed to you so they can argue with you about it before your Lord?" Then will you not reason?
77. But do they not know that Allāh knows what they conceal and what they declare?
78. And among them are unlettered ones who do not know the Scripture except [indulgement in] wishful thinking, but they are only assuming.
79. So woe²⁸ to those who write the "scripture" with their own hands, then say, "This is from Allāh," in order to exchange it for a small price. Woe to them for what their hands have written and woe to them for what they earn.
80. And they say, "Never will the Fire touch us, except for [a few] numbered days." Say, "Have you taken a covenant with Allāh? For Allāh will never break His covenant. Or do you say about Allāh that which you do not know?"
81. Yes, [on the contrary], whoever earns evil and his sin has encompassed him – those are the companions of the Fire; they will abide therein eternally.
82. But they who believe and do righteous deeds – those are the companions of Paradise; they will abide therein eternally.
83. And [recall] when We took the covenant from the Children of Israel, [enjoining upon them], "Do not worship except Allāh; and to parents do good and to relatives, orphans, and the needy. And speak to people good [words] and establish prayer and give zakāh." Then you turned away, except a few of you, and you were refusing.

28. i.e., death and destruction.

84. And [recall] when We took your covenant, [saying], "Do not shed your [i.e., each other's] blood or evict one another from your homes." Then you acknowledged [this] while you were witnessing.
85. Then, you are those [same ones who are] killing one another and evicting a party of your people from their homes, cooperating against them in sin and aggression. And if they come to you as captives, you ransom them, although their eviction was forbidden to you. So do you believe in part of the Scripture and disbelieve in part? Then what is the recompense for those who do that among you except disgrace in worldly life; and on the Day of Resurrection they will be sent back to the severest of punishment. And Allāh is not unaware of what you do.
86. Those are the ones who have bought the life of this world [in exchange] for the Hereafter, so the punishment will not be lightened for them, nor will they be aided.
87. And We did certainly give Moses the Scripture [i.e., the Torah] and followed up after him with messengers. And We gave Jesus, the son of Mary, clear proofs and supported him with the Pure Spirit [i.e., the angel Gabriel]. But is it [not] that every time a messenger came to you, [O Children of Israel], with what your souls did not desire, you were arrogant? And a party [of messengers] you denied and another party you killed.
88. And they said, "Our hearts are wrapped."²⁹ But, [in fact], Allāh has cursed them for their disbelief, so little is it that they believe.
89. And when there came to them a Book [i.e., the Qur'ān] from Allāh confirming that which was with them – although before they used to pray for victory against those who disbelieved – but [then] when there came to them that which they recognized, they disbelieved in it; so the curse of Allāh will be upon the disbelievers.

²⁹Covered or sealed against reception of Allāh's word.

90. How wretched is that for which they sold themselves – that they would disbelieve in what Allāh has revealed through [their] outrage that Allāh would send down His favor upon whom He wills from among His servants. So they returned having [earned] wrath upon wrath. And for the disbelievers is a humiliating punishment.
91. And when it is said to them, "Believe in what Allāh has revealed," they say, "We believe [only] in what was revealed to us." And they disbelieve in what came after it, while it is the truth confirming that which is with them. Say, "Then why did you kill the prophets of Allāh before, if you are [indeed] believers?"
92. And Moses had certainly brought you clear proofs. Then you took the calf [in worship] after that, while you were wrongdoers.
93. And [recall] when We took your covenant and raised over you the mount, [saying], "Take what We have given you with determination and listen." They said [instead], "We hear and disobey." And their hearts absorbed [the worship of] the calf because of their disbelief. Say, "How wretched is that which your faith enjoins upon you, if you should be believers."
94. Say, [O Muḥammad], "If the home of the Hereafter with Allāh is for you alone and not the [other] people, then wish for death, if you should be truthful."
95. But never will they wish for it, ever, because of what their hands have put forth. And Allāh is Knowing of the wrongdoers.
96. And you will surely find them the most greedy of people for life – [even] more than those who associate others with Allāh. One of them wishes that he could be granted life a thousand years, but it would not remove him in the least from the [coming] punishment that he should be granted life. And Allāh is Seeing of what they do.
97. Say, "Whoever is an enemy to Gabriel – it is [none but] he who has brought it [i.e., the Qur'ān] down upon your heart, [O Muḥammad], by permission of Allāh, confirming that which was before it and as guidance and good tidings for the believers."

98. Whoever is an enemy to Allāh and His angels and His messengers and Gabriel and Michael – then indeed, Allāh is an enemy to the disbelievers.
99. And We have certainly revealed to you verses [which are] clear proofs, and no one would deny them except the defiantly disobedient.
100. Is it not [true] that every time they took a covenant a party of them threw it away? But, [in fact], most of them do not believe.
101. And when a messenger from Allāh came to them confirming that which was with them, a party of those who had been given the Scripture threw the Scripture of Allāh [i.e., the Torah] behind their backs as if they did not know [what it contained].
102. And they followed [instead] what the devils had recited during the reign of Solomon. It was not Solomon who disbelieved, but the devils disbelieved, teaching people magic and that which was revealed to the two angels at Babylon, Hārūt and Mārūt. But they [i.e., the two angels] do not teach anyone unless they say, "We are a trial, so do not disbelieve [by practicing magic]."³⁰ And [yet] they learn from them that by which they cause separation between a man and his wife. But they do not harm anyone through it except by permission of Allāh. And they [i.e., people] learn what harms them and does not benefit them. But they [i.e., the Children of Israel] certainly knew that whoever purchased it [i.e., magic] would not have in the Hereafter any share. And wretched is that for which they sold themselves, if they only knew.
103. And if they had believed and feared Allāh, then the reward from Allāh would have been [far] better, if they only knew.
104. O you who have believed, say not [to Allāh's Messenger], "Rā'inā" but say, "Unthurnā"³¹ and listen. And for the

³⁰They warn people against the misuse of what they have learned.

³¹The word "rā'inā" in Arabic literally means "consider us," i.e., give us time to hear you and listen to us. The Jews used to use the same word with the meaning of an insult. Therefore, the believers were ordered to →

disbelievers is a painful punishment.

105. Neither those who disbelieve from the People of the Scripture [i.e., the Jews and Christians] nor the polytheists wish that any good should be sent down to you from your Lord. But Allāh selects for His mercy whom He wills, and Allāh is the possessor of great bounty.
106. We do not abrogate a verse or cause it to be forgotten except that We bring forth [one] better than it or similar to it. Do you not know that Allāh is over all things competent?
107. Do you not know that to Allāh belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth and [that] you have not besides Allāh any protector or any helper?
108. Or do you intend to ask³² your Messenger as Moses was asked before? And whoever exchanges faith for disbelief has certainly strayed from the soundness of the way.
109. Many of the People of the Scripture wish they could turn you back to disbelief after you have believed, out of envy from themselves [even] after the truth has become clear to them. So pardon and overlook until Allāh delivers His command. Indeed, Allāh is over all things competent.
110. And establish prayer and give zakāh, and whatever good you put forward for yourselves – you will find it with Allāh. Indeed Allāh, of what you do, is Seeing.
111. And they say, "None will enter Paradise except one who is a Jew or a Christian." That is [merely] their wishful thinking. Say, "Produce your proof, if you should be truthful."
112. Yes, [on the contrary], whoever submits his face [i.e., self] in Islām to Allāh while being a doer of good will have his reward with his Lord. And no fear will there be concerning them, nor will they grieve.

avoid this expression and use instead the word "*unthurnā*," i.e., "wait for us [so that we may understand]."

³² i.e., persistently question or, as in the case of the disbelievers, demand a miracle of the Prophet (ﷺ).

113. The Jews say, "The Christians have nothing [true] to stand on," and the Christians say, "The Jews have nothing to stand on," although they [both] recite the Scripture. Thus do those who know not [i.e., the polytheists] speak the same as their words. But Allāh will judge between them on the Day of Resurrection concerning that over which they used to differ.
114. And who are more unjust than those who prevent the name of Allāh from being mentioned [i.e., praised] in His mosques and strive toward their destruction. It is not for them to enter them except in fear. For them in this world is disgrace, and they will have in the Hereafter a great punishment.
115. And to Allāh belongs the east and the west. So wherever you [might] turn, there is the Face³³ of Allāh. Indeed, Allāh is all-Encompassing and Knowing.
116. They say, "Allāh has taken a son." Exalted is He!³⁴ Rather, to Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth. All are devoutly obedient to Him.
117. Originator of the heavens and the earth. When He decrees a matter, He only says to it, "Be," and it is.
118. Those who do not know say, "Why does Allāh not speak to us or there come to us a sign?" Thus spoke those before them like their words. Their hearts resemble each other. We have shown clearly the signs to a people who are certain [in faith].
119. Indeed, We have sent you, [O Muḥammad], with the truth as a bringer of good tidings and a warner, and you will not be asked about the companions of Hellfire.
120. And never will the Jews and the Christians approve of you until you follow their religion. Say, "Indeed, the guidance of Allāh is the [only] guidance." If you were to follow their desires after what has come to you of knowledge, you would have against Allāh no protector or helper.

³³See footnote to 2:19.

³⁴*Subḥānahu* means "far exalted is He above all they falsely attribute to Him."

121. Those to whom We have given the Book recite it with its true recital.³⁵ They [are the ones who] believe in it. And whoever disbelieves in it – it is they who are the losers.
122. O Children of Israel, remember My favor which I have bestowed upon you and that I preferred you over the worlds.
123. And fear a Day when no soul will suffice for another soul³⁶ at all, and no compensation will be accepted from it, nor will any intercession benefit it, nor will they be aided.
124. And [mention, O Muḥammad], when Abraham was tried by his Lord with words [i.e., commands] and he fulfilled them. [Allāh] said, "Indeed, I will make you a leader for the people." [Abraham] said, "And of my descendants?" [Allāh] said, "My covenant does not include the wrongdoers."
125. And [mention] when We made the House [i.e., the Ka'bah] a place of return for the people and [a place of] security. And take, [O believers], from the standing place of Abraham a place of prayer. And We charged Abraham and Ishmael, [saying], "Purify My House for those who perform ṭawāf³⁷ and those who are staying [there] for worship and those who bow and prostrate [in prayer]."
126. And [mention] when Abraham said, "My Lord, make this a secure city and provide its people with fruits – whoever of them believes in Allāh and the Last Day." [Allāh] said, "And whoever disbelieves – I will grant him enjoyment for a little; then I will force him to the punishment of the Fire, and wretched is the destination."
127. And [mention] when Abraham was raising the foundations of the House and [with him] Ishmael, [saying], "Our Lord, accept [this] from us. Indeed, You are the Hearing, the Knowing."

³⁵ i.e., applying its teachings to their lives.

³⁶ See footnote to 2:48.

³⁷ A form of worship particular to the *Ka'bah* consisting of going around it in circuits.

128. Our Lord, and make us Muslims [in submission] to You and from our descendants a Muslim nation [in submission] to You. And show us our rites [of ḥajj and 'umrah] and accept our repentance. Indeed, You are the Accepting of repentance, the Merciful.
129. Our Lord, and send among them a messenger from themselves who will recite to them Your verses and teach them the Book and wisdom and purify them. Indeed, You are the Exalted in Might, the Wise."
130. And who would be averse to the religion of Abraham except one who makes a fool of himself. And We had chosen him in this world, and indeed he, in the Hereafter, will be among the righteous.
131. When his Lord said to him, "Submit," he said, "I have submitted [in Islām]³⁸ to the Lord of the worlds."
132. And Abraham instructed his sons [to do the same] and [so did] Jacob, [saying], "O my sons, indeed Allāh has chosen for you this religion, so do not die except while you are Muslims."
133. Or were you witnesses when death approached Jacob, when he said to his sons, "What will you worship after me?" They said, "We will worship your God and the God of your fathers, Abraham and Ishmael and Isaac – one God.³⁹ And we are Muslims [in submission] to Him."
134. That was a nation which has passed on. It will have [the consequence of] what it earned, and you will have what you have earned. And you will not be asked about what they used to do.
135. They say, "Be Jews or Christians [so] you will be guided."

³⁸The meaning of the word "Islām" is "submission to the will of Allāh." This is the way of life ordained by Allāh and taught by all of the prophets from Adam to Muḥammad (ﷺ). A Muslim is one who submits himself to Allāh.

³⁹Allāh (*subḥānahu wa ta'ālā*) alone.

- Say, "Rather, [we follow] the religion of Abraham, inclining toward truth, and he was not of the polytheists."⁴⁰
136. Say, [O believers], "We have believed in Allāh and what has been revealed to us and what has been revealed to Abraham and Ishmael and Isaac and Jacob and the Descendants [al-Asbāt]⁴¹ and what was given to Moses and Jesus and what was given to the prophets from their Lord. We make no distinction between any of them, and we are Muslims [in submission] to Him."
137. So if they believe in the same as you believe in, then they have been [rightly] guided; but if they turn away, they are only in dissension, and Allāh will be sufficient for you against them. And He is the Hearing, the Knowing.
138. [And say, "Ours is] the religion of Allāh. And who is better than Allāh in [ordaining] religion? And we are worshippers of Him."
139. Say, [O Muḥammad], "Do you argue with us about Allāh while He is our Lord and your Lord? For us are our deeds, and for you are your deeds. And we are sincere [in deed and intention] to Him."
140. Or do you say that Abraham and Ishmael and Isaac and Jacob and the Descendants were Jews or Christians? Say, "Are you more knowing or is Allāh?" And who is more unjust than one who conceals a testimony⁴² he has from Allāh? And Allāh is not unaware of what you do.
141. That is a nation which has passed on. It will have [the consequence of] what it earned, and you will have what you have earned. And you will not be asked about what they used to do.

⁴⁰Those who associate others with Allāh in worship.

⁴¹The twelve tribes of Israel descended from Jacob.

⁴²Statements in previous scriptures attesting to the nature of Allāh's religion (Islām) and the coming of Prophet Muḥammad (ﷺ).

142. The foolish among the people will say, "What has turned them away from their qiblah,⁴³ which they used to face?"⁴⁴ Say, "To Allāh belongs the east and the west. He guides whom He wills to a straight path."
143. And thus We have made you a median [i.e., just] community that you will be witnesses over the people and the Messenger will be a witness over you. And We did not make the qiblah which you used to face except that We might make evident who would follow the Messenger from who would turn back on his heels. And indeed, it is difficult except for those whom Allāh has guided. And never would Allāh have caused you to lose your faith [i.e., your previous prayers]. Indeed Allāh is, to the people, Kind and Merciful.
144. We have certainly seen the turning of your face, [O Muḥammad], toward the heaven, and We will surely turn you to a qiblah with which you will be pleased. So turn your face [i.e., yourself] toward al-Masjid al-Ḥarām.⁴⁵ And wherever you [believers] are, turn your faces [i.e., yourselves] toward it [in prayer]. Indeed, those who have been given the Scripture [i.e., the Jews and the Christians] well know that it is the truth from their Lord. And Allāh is not unaware of what they do.
145. And if you brought to those who were given the Scripture every sign, they would not follow your qiblah. Nor will you be a follower of their qiblah. Nor would they be followers of one another's qiblah. So if you were to follow their desires after what has come to you of knowledge, indeed, you would then be among the wrongdoers.

⁴³The direction faced in prayer.

⁴⁴Prior to the command (in verse 144) that the Prophet (ﷺ) and his followers turn toward the *Ka'bah* in Makkah for prayer, they had been facing Jerusalem to the north. The implications of this change are mentioned in succeeding verses.

⁴⁵The Sacred Mosque in Makkah containing the *Ka'bah*.

146. Those to whom We gave the Scripture know him [i.e., Prophet Muḥammad (ﷺ)] as they know their own sons. But indeed, a party of them conceal the truth while they know [it].
147. The truth is from your Lord, so never be among the doubters.
148. For each [religious following] is a [prayer] direction toward which it faces. So race to [all that is] good. Wherever you may be, Allāh will bring you forth [for judgement] all together. Indeed, Allāh is over all things competent.
149. So from wherever you go out [for prayer, O Muḥammad], turn your face toward al-Masjid al-Ḥarām, and indeed, it is the truth from your Lord. And Allāh is not unaware of what you do.
150. And from wherever you go out [for prayer], turn your face toward al-Masjid al-Ḥarām. And wherever you [believers] may be, turn your faces toward it in order that the people will not have any argument against you, except for those of them who commit wrong; so fear them not but fear Me. And [it is] so I may complete My favor upon you and that you may be guided,
151. Just as We have sent among you a messenger from yourselves reciting to you Our verses and purifying you and teaching you the Book and wisdom⁴⁶ and teaching you that which you did not know.
152. So remember Me; I will remember you. And be grateful to Me and do not deny Me.
153. O you who have believed, seek help through patience and prayer. Indeed, Allāh is with the patient.
154. And do not say about those who are killed in the way of Allāh, "They are dead." Rather, they are alive, but you perceive [it] not.
155. And We will surely test you with something of fear and hunger and a loss of wealth and lives and fruits, but give good tidings to the patient,

⁴⁶The wisdom taught by the Prophet (ﷺ) is his *sunnah*.

156. Who, when disaster strikes them, say, "Indeed we belong to Allāh, and indeed to Him we will return."
157. Those are the ones upon whom are blessings from their Lord and mercy. And it is those who are the [rightly] guided.
158. Indeed, aṣ-Ṣafā and al-Marwah are among the symbols⁴⁷ of Allāh. So whoever makes ḥajj [pilgrimage] to the House or performs 'umrah – there is no blame upon him for walking between them.⁴⁸ And whoever volunteers good – then indeed, Allāh is Appreciative and Knowing.
159. Indeed, those who conceal what We sent down of clear proofs and guidance after We made it clear for the people in the Scripture – those are cursed by Allāh and cursed by those who curse.⁴⁹
160. Except for those who repent and correct themselves and make evident [what they concealed]. Those – I will accept their repentance, and I am the Accepting of repentance, the Merciful.
161. Indeed, those who disbelieve and die while they are disbelievers – upon them will be the curse of Allāh and of the angels and the people, all together,
162. Abiding eternally therein. The punishment will not be lightened for them, nor will they be reprieved.
163. And your god is one God. There is no deity [worthy of worship] except Him, the Entirely Merciful, the Especially Merciful.
164. Indeed, in the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the alternation of the night and the day, and the [great] ships which sail through the sea with that which benefits people, and what Allāh has sent down from the heavens of rain, giving life thereby to the earth after its lifelessness and dispersing therein every [kind of] moving creature, and [His]

⁴⁷Places designated for the rites of ḥajj and 'umrah.

⁴⁸Some believers had previously feared that this might be a pagan practice, so Allāh confirms that *sa'i* is among the rites of His religion.

⁴⁹From among the angels and the believers.